

Crop farming

Among the first crops to be farmed were peas, lentils, and wheat. These could all be stored for a long time. Having extra food that was stored gave people a much better chance of surviving a hard winter or a drought.

Grinding stone



Shifting to farming meant that new stone tools were needed. People began using coarse stones to grind grains into flour.

Planting seeds at the right time of year was very important.

Instead of planning around the yearly hunt, a farmer's life now focused on the harvest.

Farmers learned to dig canals to route water from lakes and rivers toward their fields. Some early canals are still in use today!

Farmers chopped down trees and used the wood for tools and to make fires.

First farmers

Toward the end of the Stone Age, people started to farm in many parts of the world. Some settled down in fixed houses to plant crops and raise farm animals. Others kept small farms but continued to hunt and gather for most of their food. As farming developed and changed, so did the plants and animals that were being farmed.